

They have relented on the chief minister's head. From now on they will call almost all the shots.



YEDDYURAPPA (LEFT) WITH SHETTAR

Minister G. Karunakara Reddy. This panel will clip Yeddyurappa's powers considerably much to the delight of the Reddys.

Yeddyurappa will soon have to roll back the decision to levy a special toll on mining trucks in Bellary, the state's mining capital, a move that was meant to fetch Rs 1,000-crore as additional revenue for the flood relief fund.

Yeddyurappa is ready to work with the Core Committee for Coordination that will include his known detractors like H.N. Ananth Kumar and Revenue

No merging with the Government's public-private partnership project to house floodhit victims. Not only will Revenue Minister Karunakara Reddy go on a



MASUTI

state tour of flood-affected districts sans the chief minister, he has also made it clear that the brothers' private initiative—the Rs 500-crore Nava Grama project to build 54,000 houses for the floodhit in six districts in and around

Bellary that was launched last fortnight—will not be merged with any other project.

Cabinet to be reshuffled and key posts will go to Reddy's men. Yeddyurappa will have to shed some of his aides to accommodate Reddy's choice of men who are eyeing key portfolios like home, forests and industries. Even if Karandlaje has to be replaced with another woman, it will be from Reddy's team of supporters, in which case BJP legislator Seema Masuti from Dharwad is the most likely choice.

Photographs by BK RAMESH



SWARAJ (CENTRE) HAS FINALLY BROUGHT CURTAINS DOWN ON THE PROLONGED SLUGFEST WHILE GOWDA (RIGHT) REMAINS FIRMLY BY THE SIDE OF YEDDYURAPPA

Brahmin officer, Ranganath has kept the wheels of administration moving quietly. Yeddyurappa can also count on other efficient IAS officers, like V. Madhu, principal secretary in the Department of Infrastructure and chairman of the state's vision group on infrastructure.

Meanwhile, Karunakara, who has announced that he will go alone on a tour of flood-affected districts, has not hidden his contempt for Yeddyurappa for seeking to humiliate the Reddy brothers. Yeddyurappa's veiled attack at a Forest Department function this week has only made things worse for himself. Karunakara recently said, "Let the (demon king) Kamsa continue to make a hundred mistakes, we will in the form of Lord Krishna finish him off."

For his own good, Yeddyurappa may have to just focus on "development, development, development" as he is fond of saying and learn to talk less. Otherwise, the floodgates of dissent may open again. Only, providence won't give him a second chance then.